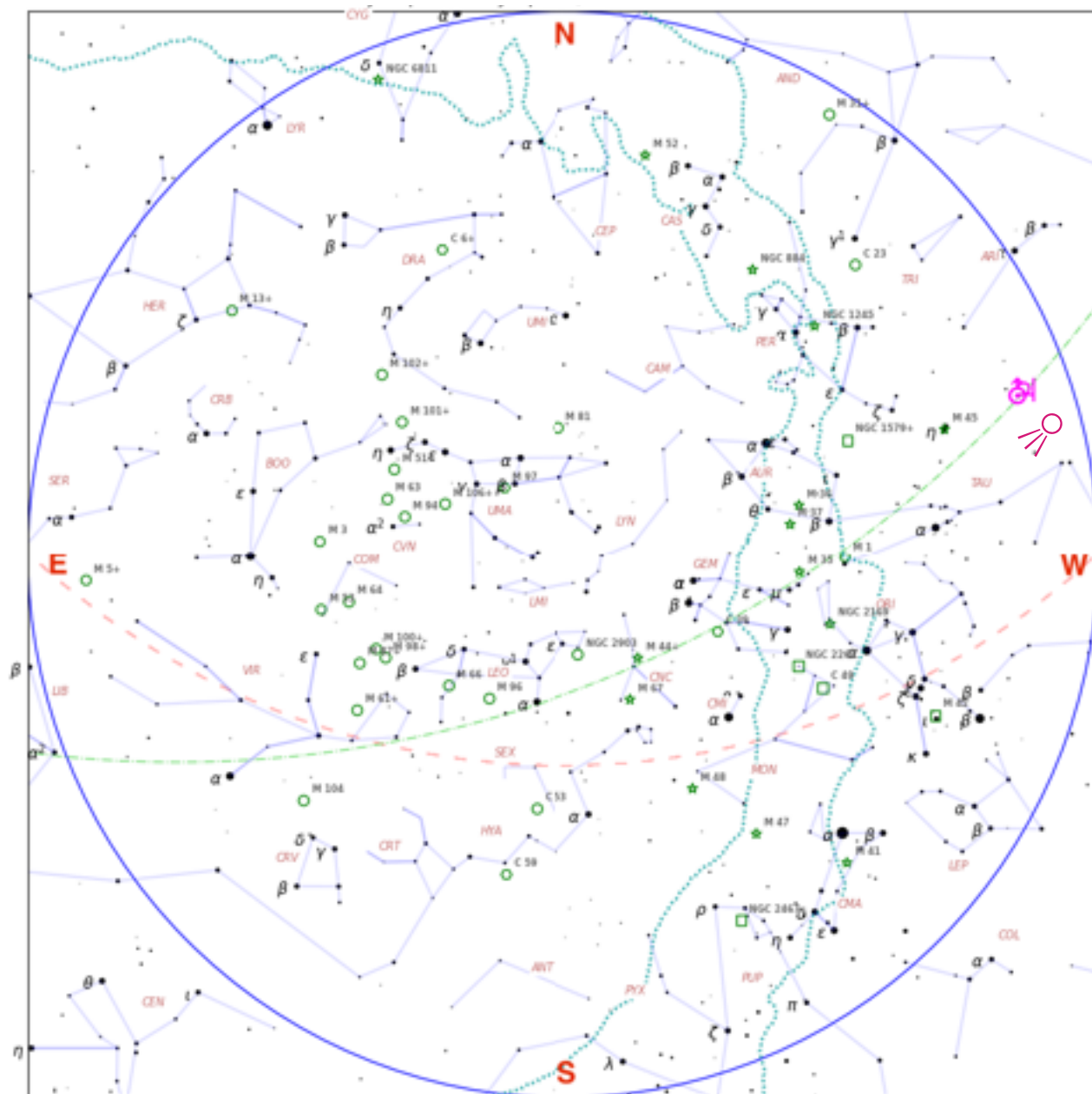


APR 2024



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Orion and the winter constellations fade into the West, as does Jupiter and Uranus. While we enter planet-less skies for a few months, we can marvel at dozens of bright galaxies as “galaxy season” is upon us!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Lady*
 ANT - Antlia - *the Air Pump*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEN - Centaurus - *the Centaur*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Big Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Little Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenice's Hair*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CRT - Crater - *the Cup*
 CRV - Corvus - *the Crow*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 CYG - Cygnus - *the Swan*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 HYA - Hydra - *the Water Snake*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LIB - Libra - *the Scales*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Little Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - *the Harp*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PUP - Puppis - *the Stern*
 PYX - Pyxis - *the Mariner's Compass*
 SER - Serpens - *the Serpent*
 SEX - Sextans - *the Sextant*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VIR - Virgo - *the Maiden*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Apr 1	10 PM (EDT)
Apr 8	9:30 PM
Apr 15	9 PM
Apr 22	8:30 PM
Apr 29	8 PM

Because of the Earth’s motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets (and a Comet)

♃ - Jupiter, ♅ - Uranus

Jupiter will still be present, briefly, after sunset. But in the vicinity is comet 12P/Pons-Brooks that will come close to the planet in the sky mid-month. If we’re lucky and the comet experiences one of its not-infrequent outbursts around that time, the two together in the sky should be magnificent.

The mid-month position of the comet is marked with an ☄ symbol. But the comet’s position starts near α Ari moving past Jupiter mid-month into Taurus at the end of the month.